

Water birds

Birds are often seen wading in waterholes, looking for fish and frogs. There are many different types, and a few are shown here.



Yellow-billed storks stir the water with a foot to disturb fish and frogs.



Saddle-billed storks are the largest storks, with a wingspan of 2.7 m (9 ft).



Crowned cranes are the only cranes able to perch in trees.



Wattled cranes surround their large nests with moat-like water channels.



Stuck in the mud

Some water holes dry up in the dry season. The African lungfish buries itself in a sticky bag of slime and hibernates until the rains come back.

A never-ending thirst

Animals visit a water hole frequently, especially elephants. Elephants have to drink about 200 litres (53 gallons) a day.

A water hole is a cool place.

African elephant

Impala

Become an expert

154-155 Food chains

164-165 A sea of grass